A small plan for a feeling teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Create art linked to an emotion (links PSHE).

Today: I can plan a small piece about a feeling.

Success criteria

I can choose a feeling for a made-up piece.

I can try two ways and choose one.

I can plan a start and an end.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four books or arts logs, four pencils and eight small scrap pieces for two tests each.

Paint route: four small trial sheets, five brushes including the adult model, four mats, two stable water pots, a small shared amount of washable paint and cloths. Use familiar materials and check access needs.

Sound route: fingertips or soft knee taps only if comfortable. No instrument or recorded sound is needed. Provide a silent option.

Adult model: two tiny tests and a short ordered plan. Keep four labelled trays or safe spaces for individual work and a flat drying space.

Materials-free route: silent hand patterns, air drawing or pupil-directed adult movement. Record an oral plan when paper becomes available.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Say: My invented piece is about hope. Touch the brush lightly to scrap and pull a short curve. Or trace it in the air.

15 to 30 seconds: Try a zigzag beside the curve. Say: I choose the curve because it seems open. These are my two tests.

30 to 45 seconds: Show one curve at the start and three spaced curves at the end. For sound, tap four soft slow beats, pause, then repeat. Say: My plan has an order.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to the trial and plan. Say: I keep my feeling, choice and reason. Tomorrow I will use this plan to make my piece.

Arrival and starter

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: You can point, speak, sign or pass. Our art can be about a made-up person. Pick joy, calm or worry. You may choose your own word.

What to say: An emotion is a feeling. Our art can show a feeling in an invented story. A made-up person might wait for a turn, get help or hear good news. Pick one feeling for your piece. You do not need to tell us about your own life. You may work quietly and show me in private.

What good looks like: The pupil chooses or confirms an emotion for an invented piece. The adult accepts a pupil's own word without asking for personal history.

Materials free fallback: Name two choices slowly. A pupil can point, sign, direct an adult or indicate a choice with an agreed gesture.

Check and response: Joy, calm, worry or another pupil-chosen feeling is valid. An adult may explain the word but does not decide what the pupil must feel.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: A made-up person waits for a turn. What might they feel? More than one idea can fit. Which marks or moves could show your idea?

What to say: Our made-up person waits for a turn. They might feel calm, glad, unsure or cross. We do not know until the maker tells us. Show one line, quiet tap or silent move that could fit your idea.

What good looks like: The pupil offers an emotion and one possible artistic feature. Different readings of the same fictional situation are accepted.

Materials free fallback: The adult shows a smooth hand path and a short zigzag path. The pupil chooses one, directs a new path or describes it in words.

Check and response: For example, a still hand could show calm or waiting. A quick zigzag could show worry or excitement. Ask the maker for the intended meaning rather than marking one feeling correct.

Modelling and cover guidance

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch two tests for the same feeling. Paint: try a curve, then a short zigzag. Sound: try soft slow taps, then soft quick taps. Choose one way to work. Plan a start and an end.

What to say: My invented piece is about hope while waiting. I touch the brush lightly to scrap paper and pull a short curve. I try a zigzag beside it. I choose the curve because it seems to open out. My small painting will start with one curve and end with three spaced curves. If I choose sound, I test four slow soft taps, then four quicker soft taps. I choose slow taps, a pause, then the same taps again. I keep the volume low. I am planning an order, not just choosing a colour. These are adult examples, not rules for your work.

What good looks like: The adult shows two small tests and links a choice to an intended emotion. The plan states a beginning and an ending. A sound plan names the actions in order, so the pupil can return to it next lesson.

Materials free fallback: Use an air drawing or silent finger moves. Show the beginning, pause and ending with the hands. A pupil may direct the adult instead of making the movement.

Check and response: Ask: 'Have I chosen a feeling and an order, or only picked a tool?' Expected: a feeling and an order. If unclear, point to the beginning and ending, then ask the pupil to choose what comes first.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the task and make two tiny tests in paint, sound or silent hand movement. Let pupils choose a feature and make a short response. Use the same timings and log prompts. No specialist demonstration is needed. If prior work is missing, use a fresh trial with today's date.

Guided practice and making

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Choose one feeling for a class piece. Try two small versions. Say what changed. Choose the first part and the last part. Finish: We chose ___ because ___.

What to say: You choose the emotion for our invented piece. I will make two versions while keeping the tool or volume the same. Tell me which marks or pace fit your idea. Then direct the start and end. Hinge: Which helps us return to the idea tomorrow: A keep only a colour word, or B keep the feeling, chosen marks or actions, and their order?

What good looks like: Each pupil makes or confirms a choice. Pupils compare a controlled change, such as curve versus zigzag or slow versus quick, and identify a useful ordered plan. The shared class model stays separate from individual evidence.

Materials free fallback: Pupils direct two silent hand sequences. The adult repeats their chosen start and end, then reads the oral plan back for confirmation.

Check and response: B keeps the feeling, action and order. If a pupil chooses A, model that the same colour could make many different pieces. Parallel check: 'Which reminder helps with sound: quiet, or four soft taps, pause, four taps?' Continue when the pupil identifies the ordered reminder.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, choose a feeling. Try two small marks, sounds or silent moves. Choose one way. Make a tiny trial piece. Plan your start and end for next time. Keep your tests and say why you chose them.

What to say: Choose paint, original sound or a silent route. For paint, use a small amount on the brush tip and test on scrap. Keep paint and water on the mat. Rinse and wipe the brush before a new colour. For sound, use four gentle fingertip taps and a pause, below talking volume. Stop on my raised hand. Change only the mark shape or pace in your two tests so you can notice its effect. Choose the version for your piece and try a tiny ordered version. In the log, keep a small plan or spoken sequence for tomorrow. A pupil may direct an adult's hands and materials.

What good looks like: Two real tests, a small original trial and a plan with a start and end. The pupil names the intended feeling and gives a feature-based reason. The plan is manageable for the next 40 minute lesson. A test may stay unfinished if the log records its true state.

Materials free fallback: Use a silent hand sequence or an air drawing, or direct the adult. Confirm an ordered plan aloud. The adult records the pupil's actual sequence, emotion and reason at the next available recording opportunity. Art materials and a device are not needed for participation.

Check and response: Example only: a hopeful piece starts with one small curve and ends with three open curves. A quiet sound version begins with four slow taps, pauses, then repeats. A pupil may choose a different pattern and explain it. Do not substitute this adult example for pupil evidence.

Review and evidence

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Show your trial to an adult or partner. Say: My piece is about ___. Say: I chose ___ because ___. Tidy and keep your plan for next time.

What to say: The maker explains the emotion. The listener says one thing they notice, such as a gap, a curve or a pause. The listener can read it differently. Ask the maker before touching the work. Use the final two minutes to cap paint, wipe mats and put the work flat to dry. Keep each pupil's own tests and ordered plan together.

What good looks like: A real feature is noticed and the pupil's intention remains their own. Tests, trial and plan are safely stored. Private sharing is equally acceptable.

Materials free fallback: The pupil directs a repeat of their silent sequence to the adult. The adult describes one observed feature and confirms the intended emotion with the pupil.

Check and response: A useful comment is 'I notice the last curves have more space.' Do not infer a private event or tell the maker what they must feel.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: My piece is about ___. I chose ___ because ___. First I will ___. At the end I will ___. Keep your real test or a note of what you did.

What to say: Tell me the feeling, one choice and the order for next time. You can draw, speak, sign or point. I can write your own words, read them back and let you correct them. We keep the actual date and support used. This plan helps tomorrow's making.

What good looks like: A dated arts-log entry links the pupil's emotion, chosen feature, reason and ordered plan to the real trial. A witness note describes what was actually seen or heard.

Materials free fallback: Confirm the feeling and ordered sequence orally. The adult keeps a short witnessed note when a recording method is available, with the actual date and support.

Check and response: Example only: My piece is about hope. I chose curves because they seem open. First I will make one small curve. At the end I will make three curves.

Access and teaching decisions

BUILD Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

The maker must tell a real personal story - Use an invented person or an abstract idea. A pupil can pass on public sharing and explain privately.

Choosing a colour is a complete plan - Add the mark or action and the beginning and ending. A short spoken sequence is a valid plan.

A feeling has one correct colour or pace - Ask the maker for their intention. Accept a different interpretation when it links a feature to a reason.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.